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EQUITY RESEARCH

Company Report

Germany

Aerospace & Defense

Airbus Group

BUY

April 29, 2026

Price: EUR 166.04

Bloomberg:
[AIR GY]

Market Cap:
EUR 131,101.00 m

Outstanding Shares:
792.28 m

Six Month Avg. Daily Trading vol. (EUR m): 52.86

52 week High/Low:
EUR 221.25 / EUR 143.50

Our positive investment thesis remains unchanged

> Following Airbus' Q1/26 results, we are maintaining our estimates for 2026e-2028e, price target of EUR 210, and BUY recommendation.

> We are not concerned about the weak performance in Q1/26, which was characterized by a significant YoY decline in adj. EBIT (to EUR 300 m) and FCF before Customer Financing (EUR -2.5 bn).

> Both metrics were impacted by lower commercial aircraft deliveries (114 units in Q1/26 compared to 136 units in Q1/25, including a 25-unit shortfall in A320 deliveries), though the Middle East conflict has not yet had a direct effect on deliveries.

> However, large quarterly fluctuations in FCF before Customer Financing and a back-end loaded delivery profile have historically been common. Additionally, Q1/26 commercial aircraft deliveries were affected by administrative issues, resulting in a delay of nearly 20 aircraft deliveries to Chinese customers, which were shifted from Q1 to Q2.

> Hence, we still believe that Airbus can achieve its full-year targets, i.e. ~870 commercial aircraft deliveries (M'e: 870), an adj. EBIT of EUR ~7.5 bn (M'e: EUR 7.6 bn), and a FCF before Customer Financing of EUR ~4.5 bn (M'e: EUR 4.7 bn).

> While the (GTF) engine supply shortage is expected to persist throughout the year - the dispute with Pratt & Whitney remains unsolved -, we recommend looking through these near-term execution challenges, as the fundamental drivers of earnings growth remain intact.

> Our investment thesis: We continue to see a strong demand outlook for narrowbody and widebody aircraft, and expect Airbus to be significantly more profitable and materially stronger in FCF generation by 2028e compared with today.

IMPORTANT DISCLOSURE ON LAST PAGE

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METZLER Capital Markets

Airbus Group (AIR GY) | Industrial Technology

April 29, 2026

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Following Airbus' Q1/26 results, we are maintaining our estimates for 2026e-2028e, price target of EUR 210, and BUY recommendation. We are not concerned about the weak performance in Q1/26, which was characterized by a significant YoY decline in adj. EBIT (to EUR 300 m) and FCF before Customer Financing (EUR -2.5 bn). Both metrics were impacted by lower commercial aircraft deliveries (114 units in Q1/26 compared to 136 units in Q1/25, including a 25-unit shortfall in A320 deliveries), though the Middle East conflict has not yet had a direct effect on deliveries. However, large quarterly fluctuations in FCF before Customer Financing and a back-end loaded delivery profile have historically been common. Additionally, Q1/26 commercial aircraft deliveries were affected by administrative issues, resulting in a delay of nearly 20 aircraft deliveries to Chinese customers, which were shifted from Q1 to Q2. Hence, we still believe that Airbus can achieve its full-year targets, i.e. ~870 commercial aircraft deliveries (M'e: 870), an adj. EBIT of EUR ~7.5 bn (M'e: EUR 7.6 bn), and a FCF before Customer Financing of EUR ~4.5 bn (M'e: EUR 4.7 bn). While the (GTF) engine supply shortage is expected to persist throughout the year - the dispute with Pratt & Whitney remains unsolved -, we recommend looking through these near-term execution challenges, as the fundamental drivers of earnings growth remain intact.

Our investment thesis: We continue to see a strong demand outlook for narrowbody and widebody aircraft, and expect Airbus to be significantly more profitable and materially stronger in FCF generation by 2028e compared with today. Adj. EBIT should increase by >50% by 2028e driven by:

Fundamentals (in EUR m)[1]	2023	2024	2025	2026e	2027e	2028e
Sales	65,446	69,230	73,420	80,377	88,695	99,641
EBITDA	6,845	8,157	9,215	10,963	12,435	14,761
EBIT	4,603	5,304	6,082	7,611	8,848	10,923
EPS adj. (EUR)	4.80	5.36	5.93	7.43	8.59	10.54
DPS (EUR)	2.80	3.00	3.20	3.60	4.20	5.00
BVPS (EUR)	22.44	24.82	33.06	35.79	40.02	45.58
Net Debt incl. Provisions	-8,011	-9,370	-10,320	-12,198	-15,324	-19,687
Ratios[1]	**2023**	**2024**	**2025**	**2026e**	**2027e**	**2028e**
EV/EBITDA	15.0	13.8	15.9	10.8	9.3	7.5
EV/EBIT	22.3	21.2	24.0	15.6	13.1	10.2
P/E adj.	29.2	28.8	33.4	22.3	19.3	15.8
Dividend yield (%)	2.0	1.9	1.6	2.2	2.5	3.0
EBITDA margin (%)	10.5	11.8	12.6	13.6	14.0	14.8
EBIT margin (%)	7.0	7.7	8.3	9.5	10.0	11.0
Net debt/EBITDA	-1.2	-1.1	-1.1	-1.1	-1.2	-1.3
PBV	6.2	6.2	6.0	4.6	4.1	3.6

[1]Sources: Bloomberg, Metzler Research, [2]Sources: ISS ESG, Metzler Research

Buy — unchanged

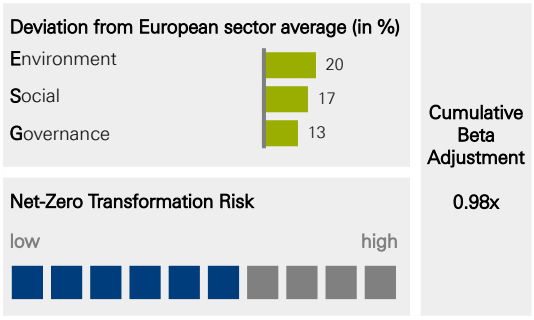
Price* EUR 166.04

Price target EUR 210.00 (unchanged)

* XETRA trading price at the close of the previous day unless stated otherwise in the Disclosures

Market Cap (EUR m)[1]	131,101
Enterprise Value (EUR m)[1]	118,903
Free Float (%)[1]	73.8

Metzler ESG analysis based on ISS ESG data[2]





Performance (in %)[1]	1m	3m	12m
Share	3.4	-14.4	15.3
Rel. to Dax 40	-4.0	-13.3	7.6

Changes in estimates (in %)[1]	2026e	2027e	2028e
Sales	0.0	0.0	0.0
EBIT	0.0	0.0	0.0
EPS	0.0	0.0	0.0



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- Rising aircraft deliveries, from 870 units in 2026e to 1,102 units in 2028e.
- A better mix on delivered aircraft led by a rising A321 share (>70% of the A320 Family order backlog.
- Improved fixed cost absorption led by the harmonization of headcount and production, and a recovered supply chain (the full operating leverage potential should become visible from '28e, when production rates have stabilised).
- A220 losses closing out.
- Better synchronization of production and deliveries.
- However, backlog execution is likely to be the primary driver of the share price. At the same time, complex supply chains, capacity constraints among suppliers, and the perception that Airbus has limited control over its supply base are likely to act as headwinds, making the production ramp-up difficult to forecast with precision.

Overview of our estimates for 2026e-2028e

(in EUR million)	2025	2026e	Yoy	2027e	Yoy	2028e	Yoy
Sales	73.420	80.377	9,5%	88.695	10,3%	99.641	12,3%
- Airbus	52.577	58.464	11,2%	65.552	12,1%	75.156	14,7%
- Helicopters	8.972	9.582	6,8%	10.253	7,0%	10.981	7,1%
- Defence & Space	13.405	13.888	3,6%	14.471	4,2%	15.108	4,4%
- Transversal / Elim.	-1.534	-1.557	-	-1.580	-	-1.604	-
Adj. EBIT	7.128	7.611	6,8%	8.848	16,3%	10.923	23,5%
- Airbus	5.470	5.802	6,1%	6.817	17,5%	8.643	26,8%
- Helicopters	925	1.006	8,8%	1.097	9,0%	1.197	9,1%
- Defence & Space	798	868	8,8%	998	15,0%	1.148	15,0%
- Transversal / Elim.	-65	-65	-	-65	-	-65	-
Adj. EBIT Margin	9,7%	9,5%	-0,2%	10,0%	0,5%	11,0%	1,0%
- Airbus	10,4%	9,9%	-0,5%	10,4%	0,5%	11,5%	1,1%
- Helicopters	10,3%	10,5%	0,2%	10,7%	0,2%	10,9%	0,2%
- Defence & Space	6,0%	6,3%	0,3%	6,9%	0,7%	7,6%	0,7%
Adj. net income	5.437	5.869	7,9%	6.784	15,6%	8.320	22,6%
Adj. EPS (in EUR)	6,89	7,43	7,9%	8,59	15,6%	10,54	22,6%
Net debt ex pensions	11.575	13.466	16,3%	16.604	23,3%	20.980	26,4%

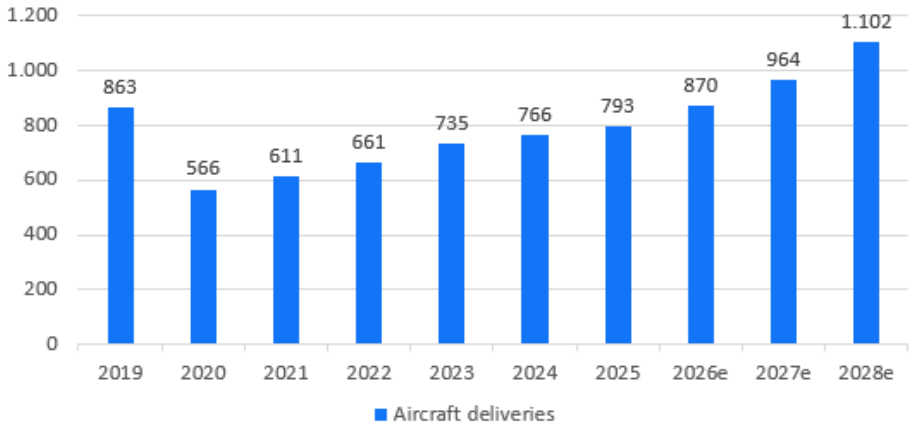
Source: Company data, Metzler Research

Commercial aircraft deliveries by programme

Programme	2019	2020	2021	2022	2023	2024	2025	2026e	2027e	2028e
A220 Family	48	38	50	53	68	75	93	107	124	148
A320 Family	642	446	483	516	571	602	607	655	717	800
A330 Family	53	19	18	32	32	32	36	37	40	46
A350 XWB Family	112	59	55	60	64	57	57	71	83	108
A380	8	4	5	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Aircraft deliveries	863	566	611	661	735	766	793	870	964	1.102
Yoy change	8%	-34%	8%	8%	11%	4%	4%	10%	11%	14%

Source: Company data, Metzler Research

We expect aircraft shipments to rise significantly despite supply chain challenges



Source: Company data, Metzler Research

SOTP model

Asset	Valuation method	2027e adj. EBIT (in EUR m)	Multiple	EV (in EUR m)
- Airbus	EV/EBIT	6.817	18,0	122.782
- Helicopters	EV/EBIT	1.097	17,0	18.650
- Defence & Space	EV/EBIT	998	17,0	16.974
- Transversal & Elim.	EV/EBIT	-65	15,0	-975
Enterprise Value				157.431
+ Net cash	13.466			
- Pension liabilities	1.268			
- Governments' refundable advances	3.822			
Equity value	165.807			
Number of shares (m)	790			
Equity Value per share (EUR)	210,00			

Source: Company data, Metzler Research

Key Data

Company profile

CEO: Guillaume Faury | CFO: Thomas Toepfer | Toulouse

Airbus is a worldwide leader in aeronautics, space and related services. The company is one of the world's leading manufacturers of commercial aircraft (from 100 to more than 600 seats), a global leader in the civil and military helicopter market and Europe's number one defence and space enterprise.

Major shareholders

French State (11%), German State (11%), Spanish State (4.2%)

Key figures

P&L (in EUR m)	2023	%	2024	%	2025	%	2026e	%	2027e	%	2028e	%
Sales	**65,446**	**11.4**	**69,230**	**5.8**	**73,420**	**6.1**	**80,377**	**9.5**	**88,695**	**10.3**	**99,641**	**12.3**
Gross profit on sales	**10,044**	**-5.0**	**10,675**	**6.3**	**10,967**	**2.7**	**12,721**	**16.0**	**14,190**	**11.5**	**16,507**	**16.3**
Gross margin (%)	15.3	-14.7	15.4	0.5	14.9	-3.1	15.8	6.0	16.0	1.1	16.6	3.6
EBITDA	**6,845**	**-14.9**	**8,157**	**19.2**	**9,215**	**13.0**	**10,963**	**19.0**	**12,435**	**13.4**	**14,761**	**18.7**
EBITDA margin (%)	10.5	-23.6	11.8	12.7	12.6	6.5	13.6	8.7	14.0	2.8	14.8	5.7
EBIT	**4,603**	**-13.6**	**5,304**	**15.2**	**6,082**	**14.7**	**7,611**	**25.1**	**8,848**	**16.3**	**10,923**	**23.5**
EBIT margin (%)	7.0	-22.4	7.7	8.9	8.3	8.1	9.5	14.3	10.0	5.3	11.0	9.9
Financial result	**166**	**166.4**	**121**	**-27.1**	**-268**	**-321.5**	**50**	**118.7**	**50**	**0.0**	**50**	**0.0**
EBT	**4,769**	**-6.0**	**5,425**	**13.8**	**5,814**	**7.2**	**7,661**	**31.8**	**8,898**	**16.1**	**10,973**	**23.3**
Taxes	1,156	23.1	1,347	16.5	1,390	3.2	1,992	43.3	2,313	16.1	2,853	23.3
Tax rate (%)	24.2	n.a.	24.8	n.a.	23.9	n.a.	26.0	n.a.	26.0	n.a.	26.0	n.a.
Net income	3,613	-12.6	4,078	12.9	4,424	8.5	5,669	28.1	6,584	16.1	8,120	23.3
Minority interests	-176	-58.6	-154	12.5	-261	-69.5	-200	23.4	-200	0.0	-200	0.0
Net Income after minorities	**3,789**	**-10.8**	**4,232**	**11.7**	**4,685**	**10.7**	**5,869**	**25.3**	**6,784**	**15.6**	**8,320**	**22.6**
Number of shares outstanding (m)	789	0.2	790	0.2	790	0.0	790	0.0	790	0.0	790	0.0
EPS adj. (EUR)	**4.80**	**-11.0**	**5.36**	**11.5**	**5.93**	**10.8**	**7.43**	**25.3**	**8.59**	**15.6**	**10.54**	**22.6**
DPS (EUR)	**2.80**	**55.6**	**3.00**	**7.1**	**3.20**	**6.7**	**3.60**	**12.5**	**4.20**	**16.7**	**5.00**	**19.0**
Dividend yield (%)	2.0	n.a.	1.9	n.a.	1.6	n.a.	2.2	n.a.	2.5	n.a.	3.0	n.a.

Cash Flow (in EUR m)	2023	%	2024	%	2025	%	2026e	%	2027e	%	2028e	%
Gross Cash Flow	**5,718**	**4.6**	**6,570**	**14.9**	**8,167**	**24.3**	**8,431**	**3.2**	**9,566**	**13.5**	**11,338**	**18.5**
Increase in working capital	**537**	**n.a.**	**832**	**n.a.**	**-172**	**n.a.**	**-240**	**n.a.**	**304**	**n.a.**	**486**	**n.a.**
Capital expenditures	**-2,901**	**-17.7**	**-3,473**	**-19.7**	**-3,577**	**-3.0**	**-3,785**	**-5.8**	**-4,047**	**-6.9**	**-4,289**	**-6.0**
D+A/Capex (%)	-77.3	n.a.	-82.1	n.a.	-87.6	n.a.	-88.6	n.a.	-88.6	n.a.	-89.5	n.a.
Free cash flow (Metzler definition)	**3,354**	**-24.2**	**3,929**	**17.1**	**4,418**	**12.4**	**4,405**	**-0.3**	**5,823**	**32.2**	**7,534**	**29.4**
Free cash flow yield (%)	3.0	n.a.	3.2	n.a.	2.8	n.a.	3.4	n.a.	4.4	n.a.	5.7	n.a.
Dividend paid	-1,421	-20.2	-2,216	-55.9	-2,374	-7.1	-2,527	-6.4	-2,842	-12.5	-3,316	-16.7
Free cash flow (post dividend)	**706**	**-72.8**	**-1,467**	**-307.8**	**939**	**164.0**	**1,879**	**100.1**	**2,980**	**58.7**	**4,218**	**41.5**

Balance sheet (in EUR m)	2023	%	2024	%	2025	%	2026e	%	2027e	%	2028e	%
Assets	**118,818**	**2.5**	**129,152**	**8.7**	**134,876**	**4.4**	**142,060**	**5.3**	**151,401**	**6.6**	**163,665**	**8.1**
Goodwill	**16,929**	**1.0**	**17,179**	**1.5**	**16,847**	**-1.9**	**16,847**	**0.0**	**16,847**	**0.0**	**16,847**	**0.0**
Shareholders' equity	**17,730**	**36.6**	**19,696**	**11.1**	**26,184**	**32.9**	**28,341**	**8.2**	**31,685**	**11.8**	**36,083**	**13.9**
Equity/total assets (%)	14.9	n.a.	15.3	n.a.	19.4	n.a.	20.0	n.a.	20.9	n.a.	22.0	n.a.
Net Debt incl. Provisions	**-8,011**	**-20.0**	**-9,370**	**-17.0**	**-10,320**	**-10.1**	**-12,198**	**-18.2**	**-15,324**	**-25.6**	**-19,687**	**-28.5**
thereof pension provisions	**2,715**	**-1.5**	**1,821**	**-32.9**	**1,255**	**-31.1**	**1,268**	**1.0**	**1,280**	**1.0**	**1,293**	**1.0**
Gearing (%)	-45.2	n.a.	-47.6	n.a.	-39.4	n.a.	-43.0	n.a.	-48.4	n.a.	-54.6	n.a.
Net debt/EBITDA	-1.2	n.a.	-1.1	n.a.	-1.1	n.a.	-1.1	n.a.	-1.2	n.a.	-1.3	n.a.

Structure

Sales by segment 2025



ESG discussion

Airbus' ambition as an aircraft manufacturer is to be a leader in the decarbonisation of aviation, as demonstrated by the unveiling in 2020 of the 'ZEROe' hybrid-hydrogen concept aircraft. A core ambition is to bring the world's first zero-emission commercial aircraft to market by 2035.

Sources: Bloomberg, Metzler Research

Disclosures

Recommendation history

Recommendations for each financial instrument or issuer - mentioned in this document - published by Metzler in the past twelve months

Date of dissemination	Metzler recommendation * Previous	Current	Current price **	Price target *	Author ***
Issuer/Financial Instrument (ISIN): Airbus Group (NL0000235190)					
03.03.2026	Buy	Buy	180.32 EUR	210.00 EUR	Bauer, Stephan
24.11.2025	Buy	Buy	202.65 EUR	235.00 EUR	Bauer, Stephan
21.07.2025	Buy	Buy	186.30 EUR	204.00 EUR	Bauer, Stephan
27.06.2025	Buy	Buy	176.00 EUR	198.00 EUR	Bauer, Stephan

* Effective until the price target and/or investment recommendation is updated (FI/FX recommendations are valid solely at the time of publication)

** XETRA trading price at the close of the previous day unless stated otherwise herein: (AMS SW: SIX Swiss Exchange)

*** All authors are financial analysts

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Valuations are based on standard and acknowledged methods of fundamental and technical analysis (e.g. DCF model, peer-group analysis, sum-of-the-parts model, relative-value analysis). The valuation models are affected by macro-economic values such as interest rates, exchange rates, commodities prices and economic performance, as well as by market sentiments. Detailed information on the valuation principles and methods used by Metzler and the assumptions on which they are based is available at: www.metzler.com/disclaimer-capital-markets-en.

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Definition of categories for investment recommendations

The categories for investment recommendations in research publications by Metzler have the following meanings:

Shares:

BUY	The price of the analysed financial instrument is expected to rise in the next 12 months.
HOLD	The price of the analysed financial instrument is expected to largely remain stable in the next 12 months.
SELL	The price of the analysed financial instrument is expected to fall in the next 12 months.

Bonds:

BUY	The analysed financial instrument is expected to perform better than similar financial instruments.
HOLD	The analysed financial instrument is not expected to perform significantly better or worse than similar financial instruments.
SELL	The analysed financial instrument is expected to perform worse than similar financial instruments.

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